Subclass 186

# Employer Nomination Scheme visa

This visa lets skilled workers, who are nominated by their employer, live and work in Australia permanently.

## Basic Eligibility

- You must have the necessary skills for the job
- You must be nominated by an Australian employer
- You must meet our health and character requirements

Employer Nomination Scheme visa (subclass 186)

## Direct Entry stream

*(https://immi.homeaffairs.gov.au/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/employer-nomination-scheme-186/direct-entry-stream)*

This visa lets skilled workers nominated by an employer live and work in Australia permanently.

- An Australian employer must nominate you
- your occupation must be on the relevant list of eligible skilled occupations.
- you must have at least Competent English.

### Stay

Permanently

### Cost

From AUD6,140.00

Concessions apply in limited circumstances.

Ask a question

### Cost Concession

From 1 July 2026, a lower visa cost applies to eligible Pacific Island and Timor-Leste citizens who lodge a valid visa application. See About this visa *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/employer-nomination-scheme-186/direct-entry-stream#About)*.

To see what your visa will cost use the Visa Pricing Estimator *(/visas/visa-pricing-estimator)*. The estimator does not consider the second instalment or other costs.

## Processing Time

For an indication of processing times for this visa, use the visa processing time guide tool *(/_layouts/15/FIXUPREDIRECT.ASPX?WebId=1057a7be-45e1-4b08-af28-b81c4827a08c&TermSetId=a76074c9-979d-4db3-adcc-34af89495da2&TermId=8d21fa49-19a7-4d58-8bb0-31134b271c2b)*. This will show the processing times for recently decided applications. It is a guide only and not specific to your application.

Employer Nomination Scheme (subclass 186)

# Labour agreement stream

*(https://immi.homeaffairs.gov.au/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/employer-nomination-scheme-186/labour-agreement-stream)*

This visa lets skilled workers nominated by their employer live and work in Australia permanently. The Labour Agreement stream might be for you if you currently work, or will work, for an employer who is party to a labour agreement.

- The employer must have a labour agreement

## Stay

Permanently

## Cost

From AUD6,140.00

Concessions apply in limited circumstances.

### Cost Concession

From 1 July 2026, a lower visa cost applies to eligible Pacific Island and Timor-Leste citizens who lodge a valid visa application. See About this

visa *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/employer-nomination-scheme-186/labour-agreement-stream#About)*.
To see what your visa will cost use the Visa Pricing Estimator. The estimator does not consider the second instalment or other costs.

## Processing Time

For an indication of processing times for this visa, use the visa processing time guide tool *(/_layouts/15/FIXUPREDIRECT.ASPX?WebId=1057a7be-45e1-4b08-af28-b81c4827a08c&TermSetId=a76074c9-979d-4db3-adcc-34af89495da2&TermId=8d21fa49-19a7-4d58-8bb0-31134b271c2b)*. This will show the processing times for recently decided applications. It is a guide only and not specific to your application.

Employer Nomination Scheme (subclass 186)

# Temporary Residence Transition stream

*(https://immi.homeaffairs.gov.au/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/employer-nomination-scheme-186/temporary-residence-transition-stream)*

This visa lets skilled workers nominated by their current employer live and work in Australia permanently.

- You must hold a subclass 457, 482 or eligible bridging visa
- Usually, you must have worked in eligible sponsored employment on a full-time basis for at least two years
- Your employer must nominate you.

## Stay

Permanent

## Cost

From AUD6,140.00
Concessions apply in limited circumstances.

### Cost Concession

From 1 July 2026, a lower visa cost applies to eligible Pacific Island and Timor-Leste citizens who lodge a valid visa application. See About this visa *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/employer-nomination-scheme-186/temporary-residence-transition-stream#About)*.
To see what your visa will cost use the Visa Pricing Estimator *(/visas/visa-pricing-estimator)*. The estimator does not consider the second instalment or other costs.

## Processing Time

For an indication of processing times for this visa, use the visa processing time guide tool *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-processing-times/global-visa-processing-times)*. This will show the processing times for recently decided applications. It is a guide only and not specific to your application.

Last updated:
5 June 2026